Slide 1: Understanding of the Indian gifting landscape and challenges

Key Takeaway: Gifting in India is a ₹6.25 lakh crore market driven by culture and occasion, but the core problem of 'helping gifters choose confidently' is completely unsolved.

Indian Gifting Market Segments

Personal (Festivals, weddings, Birthdays)

Still largely offline. Dominated by sweets, apparel, cash envelopes. Consumers increasingly want personalization but don't know how to achieve it.

Corporate (Diwali, Onboarding)

Top gifts: gift vouchers (24%), bags (16%), stationery (15%). Budgets rising from ₹2,500 to ₹4,000 per employee.

Experience (Travel, Activities, Spa)

Travel, spa, concerts. Younger urban shoppers prefer experiences over objects. Currently underdeveloped in India's gifting platforms. High growth among urban youth.

Personalized / custom (Photo Frame, Mugs)

67% of Indian millennials open to spending more on personalized gifts. Packaging and presentation now as important as the gift itself.

Market Size

₹6.25L Cr

Total gifting market

2024 value ($75.16 Bn) Growing at 3.5% CAGR to 2030

₹92K Cr

Corporate gifting segment

~12-16% of total market

₹2L Cr

Diwali gifting alone

50 million+ gifts exchanged per Diwali season

17.7%

Gift card market CAGR

₹11.5K Cr in 2024 to ₹31.5K Cr by 2030

Consumer Challenges

Gifting is emotionally stressful

- 40-60% of people feel pressure in gift-giving, intensified for millennials and unfamiliar recipients.
- ₹950 Cr wasted annually on unwanted gifts in India
- Key pain point is finding thoughtful vs. generic items, avoiding duplicates, and navigating traditions

Existing platforms solve discovery, not decision

- Gifting Platforms like FNP, IGP, Amazon provides thousands of options but not a recommendation to users
- These platforms have generic filters, not signal extraction based on recipient's profile which leads to generic results for each user

Sources:

1) https://www.techsciresearch.com/report/india-gifting-market
2) https://www.researchandmarkets.com/report/india-gifting-market
3) https://www.imarcgroup.com/india-gifting-market

Key Market Drivers

Personalization is the new baseline: Personalization has moved from differentiator to expectation. Platforms that offer generic options are losing to those that demonstrate they know the recipient.

AI gifting is an emerging category: Consumers are already ready to accept AI as a gifting aid. The gap is that no current platform uses AI to understand the recipient deeply

Rising India middle class disposable income: More disposable income, more occasions, higher expectations of thoughtfulness which leads to more anxiety about getting it right.

Slide 2: Competitive research and key insights

Key Takeaway: Existing platforms help users browse gifts, but none help them feel confident about their final choice.

Capability	IGP	Ferns N Petals	Amazon India	Giftster	My Idea *(Giftsense)*
Delivery	✓ Available	✓ Available	✓ Available	✗ Not available	✗ Not available
Personalized product options	✓ Available	✓ Available	⚠ Partially Available	✗ Not available	✗ Not available
Budget filtering	✓ Available	✓ Available	✓ Available	✓ Available	✓ Available
Relationship-depth input	⚠ Available (very basic)	✗ Not available	✗ Not available	✓ Available (Age/Gender)	✓ Full Profile analysis
Recipient personality questions	✗ Not available	✗ Not available	✗ Not available	⚠ Partially available	✓ Available
Signals / Context from Whatsapp chat	✗ Not available	✗ Not available	✗ Not available	✗ Not available	✓ Available
AI based recommendation	✗ Not available	✗ Not available	✗ Not available	✗ Not available	✓ Available
Why this gift explanation	✗ Not available	✗ Not available	✗ Not available	⚠ Available (partial)	✓ Detailed explanation available

Gifting Platforms | Gifting recommendation | My Idea *(Giftsense)*

Key insights:

- **No one reduces social risk:** Every existing platform sells thousands of products rather than helping givers feel certain about a specific gift. No player explains why a gift is appropriate for a relationship.
- **Indian context is ignored by all existing recommendation tools:** Global recommendation tools (Giftster, other AI tools) don't consider for India's multi-layered relational gifting like the importance of occasion (Diwali, Rakhi, Bhai Dooj).
- **Limited understanding of recipient's preferences:** No tools is understanding recipients from multiple signals while providing recommendation options.

What is a gap that I will address?

- **Giver anxiety is unsolved:** The core problem of "Will they actually like this?" is not addressed by any Indian player. Confidence-building understanding on 'Why this gift matters?', reason-for-recommendation UX, are entirely absent in the market today.
- **Recipient profiling doesn't exist:** No Indian gifting platform collects recipient personality, interests, or lifestyle signals. The giver must do this mental work themselves. A structured profiling step before recommendations would be novel in this market.
- **Signals from untapped sources:** I will utilize whatsapp chat to get signals and insights of user needs.

Slide 3: Chosen segment and justification of impact

Key Takeaway: Partner gifting is the highest-stakes, highest-frequency segment (recurring at least 3-5 times a year per user) making it the strongest product-market fit for an AI recommended engine.

Segment 1 (Focal): Buys gifts for Spouse / Partner

I don't want it to look like I didn't put effort

Name: Shantanu
Age: 28
Profile: Wants gift to be perfect

- Buys birthday/anniversary gift for partner and want it to feel special and meaningful
- Starts thinking weeks in advance

Pain points:
- Spends hours/days browsing across multiple apps
- No way to connect memories to actual gift idea
- Ends up with decision fatigue and mental exhaustion

Just give me something that works

Name: Aditya
Age: 35
Profile: Needs gift at last-minute

- Decides in panic
- Defaults to safe gifts
- Opens Amazon / Googles for "best gifts for girlfriend"

Pain points:
- No time to research and compare options from multiple places
- Relies on Google and Amazon searches

Segment 2 (Secondary): Buys gifts for Family & Close friends

I want to show that I have put in efforts while choosing this gift

Name: Roshni
Age: 19
Profile: Needs emotional gift

- Thinks about shared memories
- Ends up settling for something generic
- Wants to give something meaningful but parents don't express preferences clearly

Pain points:
- Needs gift that is right for occasion and relationship
- Doesn't want gift too look too cheap or too expensive

Segment 3: Buys gifts for colleagues, acquaintances and relatives

Don't want to make it awkward but it should not be generic as well

Name: Rakesh
Age: 45
Profile: Doesn't need generic gifts

- Doesn't know person deeply
- Chooses universally acceptable gifts
- Doesn't want to spend time thinking

Pain points:
- Doesn't know recipient personally
- Limited to generic categories
- Gets irritated by endless browsing

Chosen Segment: Segment 1 (Buys gifts for Spouse / Partner)
Justification:
- India's Valentine's Day market alone is ₹28,000 crore and growing. This is a just a single occasion apart from anniversaries, birthdays, and spontaneous gifting. Combining this will become recurring gifting of at least 3-5 times per year per user.
- Partner gifting has the highest emotional stakes, the most recurring occasion frequency, and the clearest product-market fit for an AI recommendation engine.

Slide 4: Insights from user research - pain points

Key Takeaway: 73% of respondents find gifting stressful. Users don't struggle to find gifts, but they struggle to make a confident, personal choice among too many options.

Key Insights

1. It's not a discovery problem of finding gifts
2. The real Problem is choosing a right gift for recipient based on personality and interest
3. Emotional relevance matters more than price or novelty
4. Too many options lead to decision paralysis

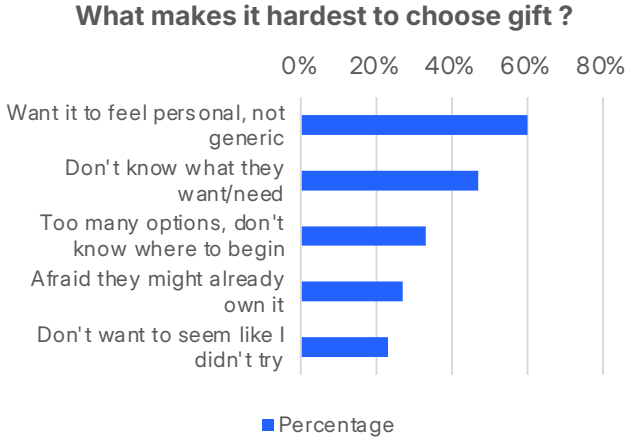
Hypothesis	(In) validate ?	Data Points	Insight
Most people find gifting stressful, not joyful	✓ Validated	73% of respondents scored the experience 3 or below (mean 2.7/5). Only 2 out of 30 rated it 5 (easy and fun).	Stress is dominant experience while choosing gift.
People struggle because they don't know recipient preferences	✓ Validated	'Not knowing what the person likes' scored highest among all 6 stress drivers. It also tops the open-ended hardest challenges list.	Gifting is a thinking problem, not a shopping problem.
People spend excessive time deciding	✓ Validated	53% spend 'multiple days' or 'several hours across a day or two'.	People don't need more options. They need confidence in gift they choose.
Social pressure (others' opinions) is a major driver of gifting anxiety	✗ Invalidated	Only 33% scored others' opinion high (4-5). 'Fear of being judged' stress score was 2.37 while is lower compared to other drivers	People care more about recipient's reaction rather than other people's judgement.
People want gifts to feel personal, not generic	✓ Validated	60% mentioned 'I want it to feel personal, not generic' as the top hardest factor.	Personalization is the core unmet need.
Budget uncertainty is a significant source of gifting stress	✗ Invalidated	Budget stress scored the lowest among all drivers. Only 13% mentioned 'unsure if my budget is appropriate' in the multi-select.	Budget is not the primary pain point; personalization and recipient knowledge are.

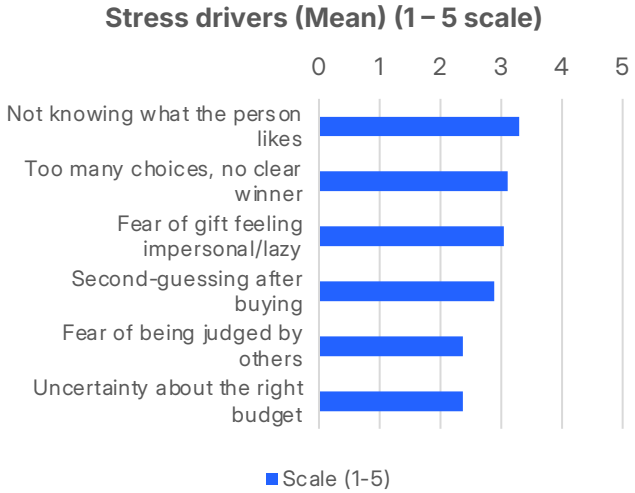
What respondents said in their own words

"I don't know what the other person might like. Also, I feel my gifts are not creative enough and it's very generic."
"Finding a gift which has usability and is personalized according to the recipient's lifestyle, this is the hardest part."
"Make them feel valued and emotionally connected, not just impressed."
"Fear of being judged what if my gift conveys the wrong signal."
"I feel pressure to pick the perfect gift, so it becomes hard to decide."

Total Responses: 30 (survey)(responses)

Dominant age: 25-34 (50% of responses)
City profile: Tier-1 cities (80% of responses)
Avg. feeling score: 2.7/5 (1 - enjoyable, 5 - stressful)





Slide 5: Problem Framing Canvas & Opportunity Sizing

Key Takeaway: This is a decision-confidence problem worth a ₹247–495 Cr SOM within a ₹1.65 lakh crore market, and the timing is right because LLMs can now 'translate relationship signals into specific, reasoned gift recommendations' at scale.

What is the true problem?

People struggle to confidently choose a meaningful gift because they cannot translate their understanding of the recipient into the right decision. Gifting is not a discovery problem, but it is a decision confidence problem.

Who are the customers facing the problem?

Urban professionals in relationships (dating/married) who want their gifts to feel thoughtful but struggle to decide. It also caters to people who want to gift their parents and close friends.

What is the value generated by solving this problem?

For the target customer

Reduces anxiety, saves time, and gives users confidence that their gift truly reflects their relationship.

For the business

Enables repeat usage across occasions, builds a strong trust layer, and opens affiliation and partnership-based monetization via premium features and commerce integration.

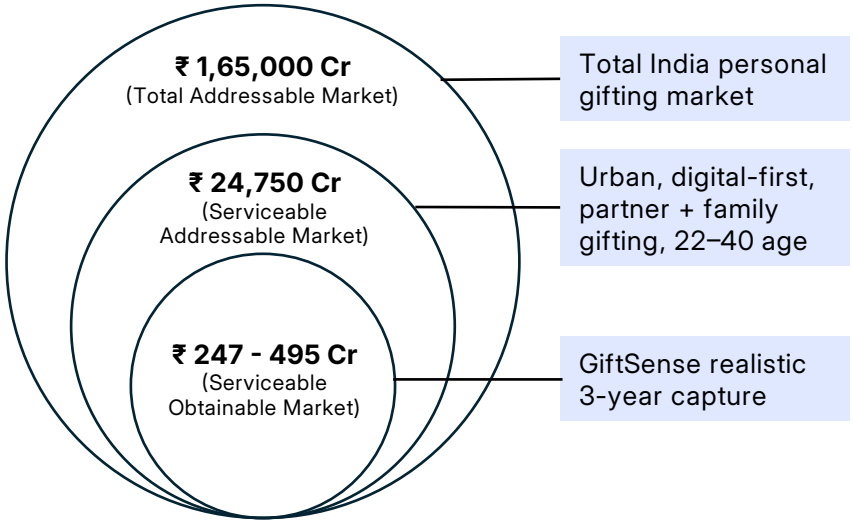
How do we know it is a real problem?

Survey shows that 73% of respondents scored the experience of buying gifts 3 or below (mean 2.7/5). Which suggests that most people find gifting stressful, not joyful. 60% mentioned 'I want it to feel personal, not generic' as the top hardest factor.

Why should we solve this problem now?

Advances in AI enable contextual understanding and reasoning, while increasing choice overload has made decision-making harder than ever. LLMs can now Interpret messy inputs, understand context and can generate meaningful reasoning. This was unsolvable earlier at scale. Now there are many new signals that can be used to determine better recommendation (like signals from whatsapp chat).

Opportunity sizing



Personal Gifting Market in India ($)	$ 20 Billion
TAM Personal Gifting Market in India (₹)	**₹ 1,65,000 Cr**
Urban millennial digital segment (Tier 1+2 cities, online-capable)	~ 15%
SAM	**₹ 24,750 Cr**
Giftsense capture via recommendation-layer positioning	~ 1-2%
SOM	**₹ 247-495 Cr**
Assumption: 1 USD = ₹ 83 (2024 rate)	

Approach and sources: Link

Slide 6: Solutions

Key Takeaway: GiftSense (RICE score 80) was chosen over a Simple Recommendation Engine (24) and a Recipient Quiz (32) because it is the only solution that directly addresses social risk through multi-signal recipient profiling.

Simple Recommendation Engine

Product-first, catalogue approach

Concept: A form-based flow collecting relationship, occasion, and budget, feeding into a basic LLM prompt to suggest popular gift products.

STRENGTHS

- Fast to build
- Familiar UX pattern
- Low friction

CONSTRAINS

- Generic outputs
- No differentiation
- Doesn't solve social risk

Recipient Quiz

Recipient inputs, high-confidence

Concept: A form-based flow collecting relationship, occasion, and budget. Creating personalized quiz using LLM (This or That) which need to be shared with recipients for signals. Feed all signals into LLM for final recommendation.

STRENGTHS

- High confidence
- Multi-signal extraction

CONSTRAINS

- Need recipient's inputs
- Complicated workflow
- Medium personalisation

Selected

GiftSense (Full Context Engine)

Signal-rich, confidence-driven

Concept: Multi-signal profiling: structured questions + optional WhatsApp chat extraction + intent selection. AI reveals who this person is (from Chat extract and other signals) before showing products.

STRENGTHS

- Deep personalisation
- WhatsApp signal extraction
- Agentic regeneration
- Confidence calibration

CONSTRAINS

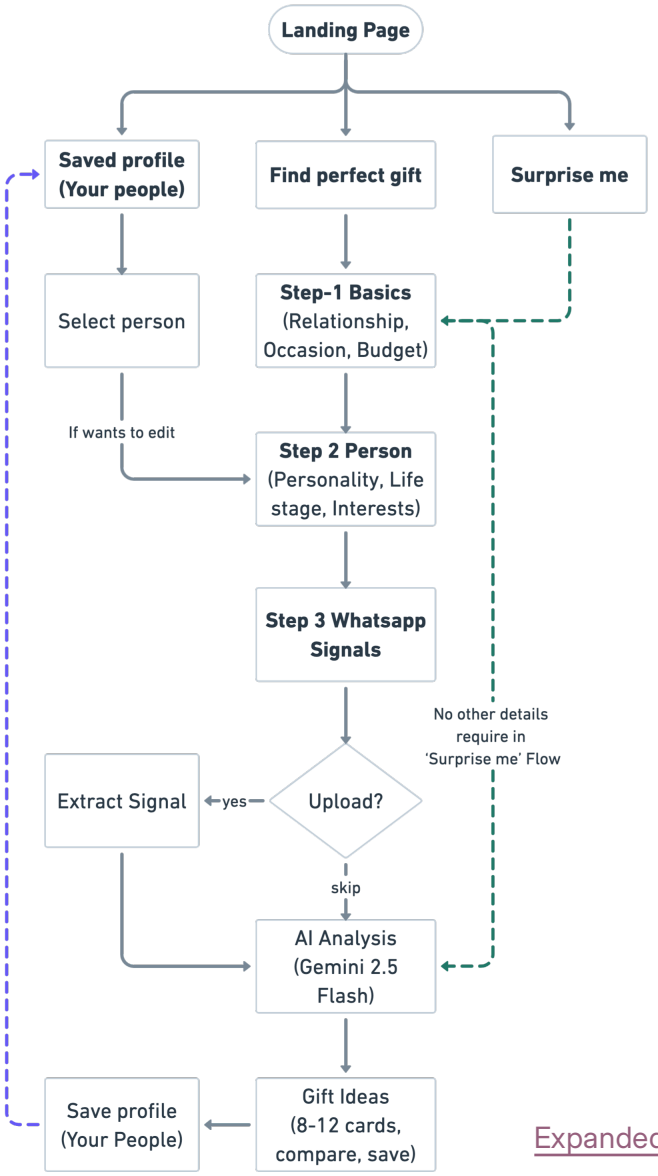
- Highest build effort
- More complex flow

Solution	Reach	Impact	Confidence	Effort	RICE Score
GiftSense (Full Context Engine)	**8** (Applies to all gifters)	**10** (Solves problem of 'Why this gift?' and confidence in choosing gift)	**8** (Multi signals provides better output)	**8** (High effort due to WhatsApp parsing, agentic generation)	**80 (P1)**
Recipient Quiz	**8** (Applies to all gifters)	**8** (Provides confidence in choosing gift)	**3** (requires recipient's input in workflow)	**6** (Screening questions + LLM call + sharing URL for recipient's inputs)	**32** (P2)
Simple Recommendation Engine	**6** (Limited to casual gifters)	**2** (generic output, doesn't reduce anxiety)	**8** (Easy to validate and use)	**4** (Standard questions + LLM call)	**24** (P3)

Slide 7: User Flow Diagram and System architecture

Key Takeaway: GiftSense is a five-layer system with React client, Next.js API routes, a Gemini LLMs, a structured prompt engineering layer, and a no-server-DB persistence model which is designed to deliver a personalized result without ever storing the user's private chat data.

User flow Diagram



Expanded view

System architecture

User Interface Layer (React, TypeScript)

- GiftContext
- Pages
- Components
- Browser storage

API routes (Node.js runtime, Rate limiting)

- /api/recommend Full gift session (25s timeout)
- /api/parse-chat WhatsApp signal extract (25s timeout)
- /api/regenerate-card Single card swap (15s timeout)

LLM Layer (Gemini API, Fallback logic)

- gemini-2.5-flash (Primary model, 25s timeout)
- 2.5-flash-lite (Quota fallback 1)
- flash-latest (Quota fallback 2)
- JSON retry (If Parse fail then re-prompt)

Prompt engineering layer (Gift recommendation)

- **System prompt** (Occasion, Relationship, intent)
- **Priority signals** (Wishes, interests, chat signals)
- **Output schema** (Portrait, Territories, Recommendations)
- **Confidence rules** high/med/low criteria

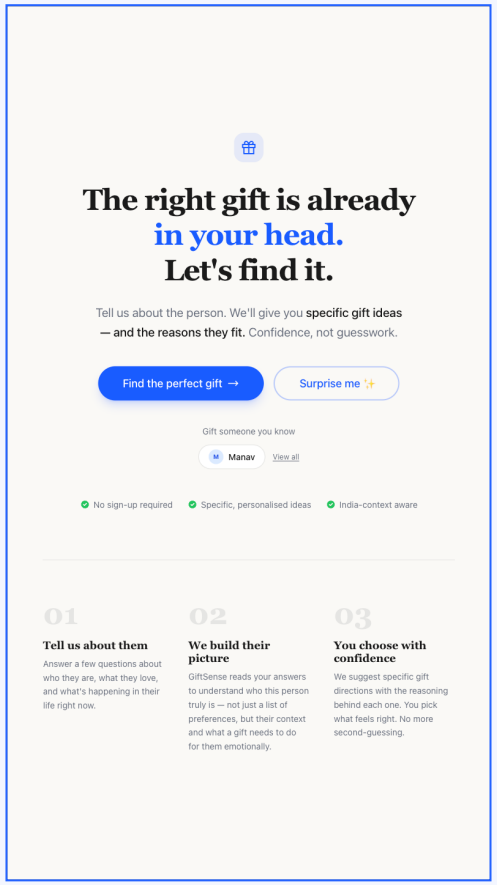
Data & Deployment layer (Local storage, Vercel, No server DB)

- Local storage (Recipient profiles, gift history)
- Session storage (Form, results, sharable URLs)
- Vercel (Deployment)
- No Server DB (Chat never stored)

Slide 8: Wireframes & Prototype

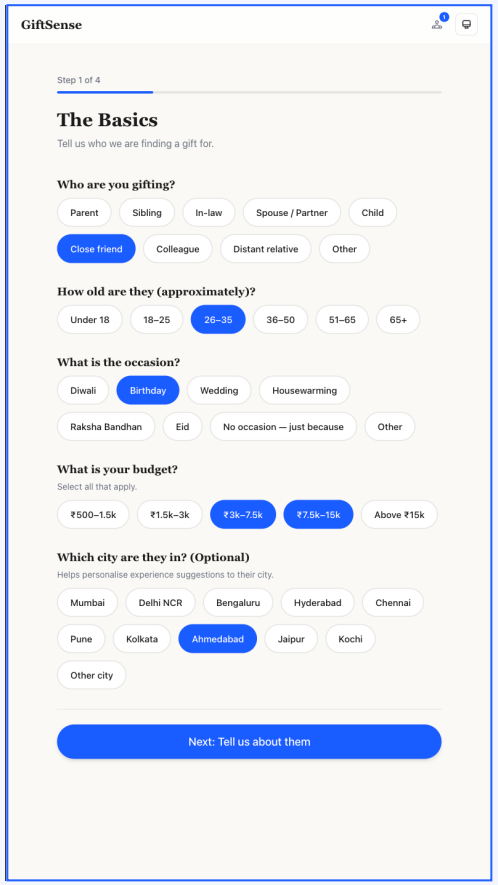
Key Takeaway: The product (link) guides users from vague thoughts to confident decisions through a simple, structured, and signal-driven flow.

Landing Page



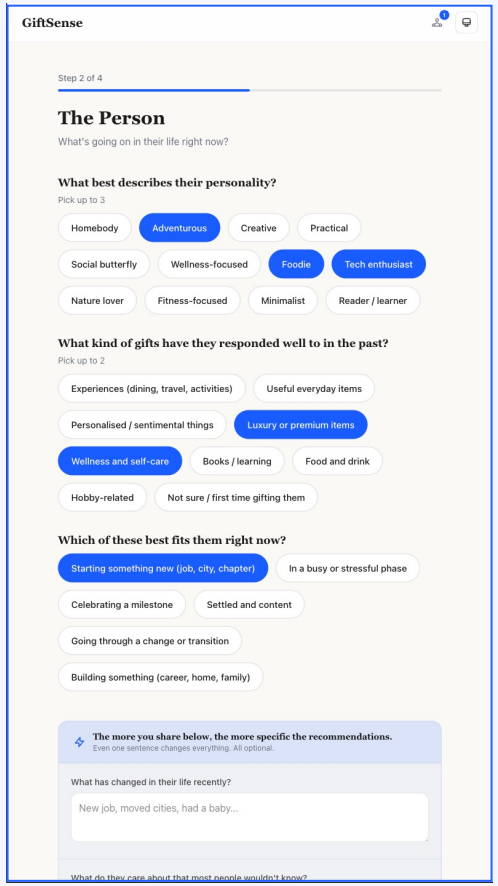
Users can do one of 3 actions: 1) Usual flow to find gifts for recipient, 2) 'Surprise me' flow to get results with basic information, 3) Re-gift flow from 'My people' section.

Step-1 Basics



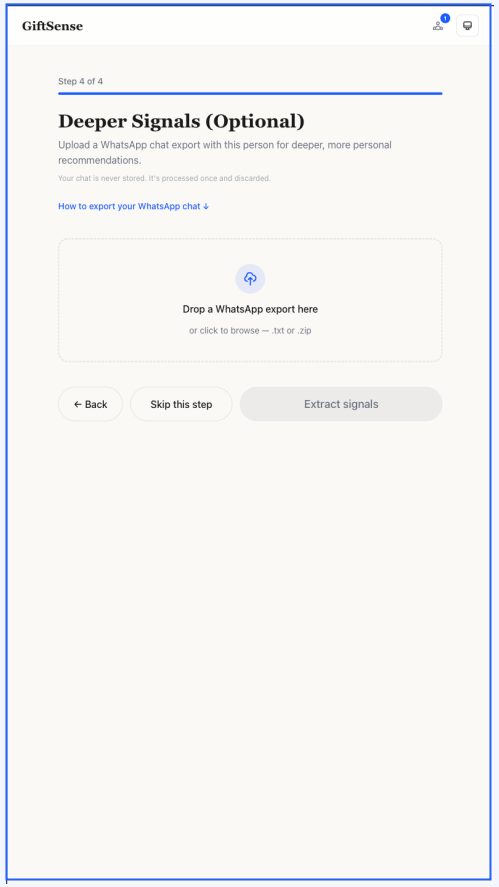
Users needs to add basic details like relationship with recipient, Occasion, Budget, etc.

Step-2 Person



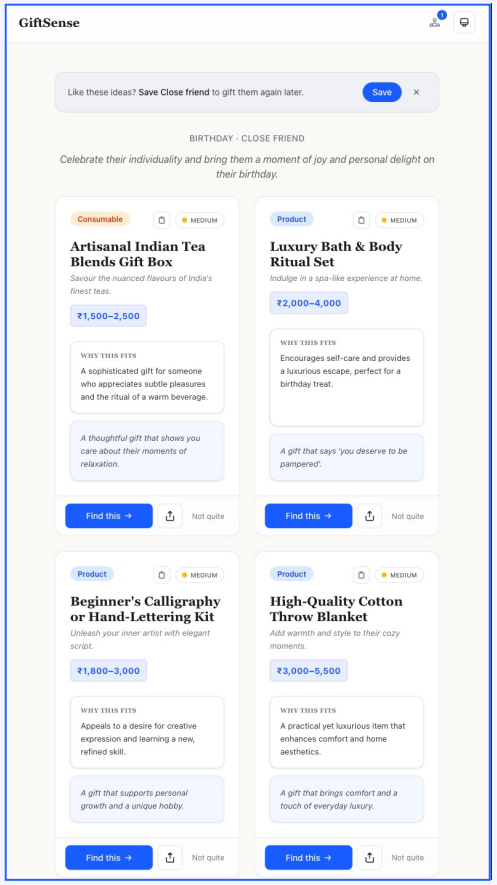
Users needs to add details on recipient's personality. These signals will be fed to LLM to get personalized results.

Step-3 WhatsApp chat upload



Users can upload whatsapp chat to generate signals from chat which will be used by LLM for personalized results.

Output – Gift Ideas



Final result page shows all recommended products with 'Budget', 'Confidence' and 'Why this gift fits' reasoning. Users can also save recipient profile for future use.

MVP: https://giftsense-rust.vercel.app/

Slide 9: Metrics & Risks

Key Takeaway: The North Star is 'Find this' button click rate which is a direct signal that users found a recommendation worth acting on. Three risks (privacy barrier to WhatsApp upload, API quota spikes, sparse input degrading LLM quality) identified, each having mitigations already in the codebase.

Solution	Metric	What it measures	Why it matters?
North Star	'Find this' button click rate on recommended products	% of sessions where user clicks 'Find this' button on atleast one product	This shows if people are finding recommendations useful.
L0 – Primary (Business outcome metrics)	Session completion rate	(Sessions reaching 'result' page) / (sessions starting 'start' page)	To monitor if users are completing session. Drop here means that 'the form', 'upload friction', or 'results reveal' is losing people before they see value.
L1 – Leading (Feature-level metrics)	WhatsApp upload rate	(Sessions with chat uploaded) / (sessions reaching 'upload' page)	If it's high, it means there is a value in signals from whatsapp chat and it improves result quality.
	Recipient profile save rate	(Profiles saved) / (total completed sessions)	It shows intent to return. It helps in improving retention rate.
L2 – Behavioral metrics	Time-on-result page	Seconds spent on 'result' page	If it's low (<8s) then users are skimming If it's high (15-30s) then users are actually reading It revels if result page quality needs redesign
Guardrail metrics	API error rate	Gemini failures and JSON parse failures combined	If it's above 3% then the core experience is unreliable.
	Step 2 abandonment	Users abandoning from step 2 'The person' page	'The Person' page is the longest step. If abandonment rate is high here means question density is too high.

Risk: Gemini API quota exceeded in peak gifting season

Why it might fail?: Diwali, Valentine's Day, and wedding season create traffic spikes. Aggregated volume for all three models (gemini-2.5-flash, flash-lite, flash-latest) might hit quota simultaneously. It can lead to fail in all sessions.

Mitigation Plan: Added 3-tier model fallback cascade (gemini-2.5-flash, flash-lite, flash-latest) and 5 req/min IP rate limiting protect from spamming and to handle traffic better.

Risk: Privacy concern kills WhatsApp upload adoption

Why it might fail?: Even with the 'chat never stored' guarantee (confirmed by the no-DB architecture), uploading an intimate conversation to an unknown web app is a significant psychological barrier, especially for Indian users with high platform distrust. If upload rate is too low, recommendation depth suffers at scale.

Mitigation Plan: To callout that 'Chat is never being stored, and it will be discarded after extracting signals'. Also, 'Whatsapp chat upload' is optional and product works fine without it.

Risk: LLM quality degrades with sparse input

Why it might fail?: When users skip optional fields and WhatsApp upload, the LLM only has relationship + occasion + budget. At this signal level outputs default to generic gifts which is exactly what the product promises to avoid. This is the most common failure mode.

Mitigation Plan: max 2 low-confidence cards shown, rest collapsed. Clearly callout that 'Deeper signals' will provide 'better ideas' on About page.

Slide 10: Revenue Model & Distribution channels

Key Takeaway: GiftSense can monetize through intent-driven affiliate actions and scale organically via whatsapp communities, SEO content, and direct HR outreach before Diwali season.

Revenue Model

1 Affiliate Commerce on every 'Find this' button (Amazon/Flipkart/Myntra affiliate programs)

The 'Find this' button already exists on every card. This is a easy change to replace a Google search URL with a tracked affiliate links. No design changes, no user behavior change, instant revenue from day 1.

Assumptions: ₹9-45 per converted 'Find this' click

EST. REVENUE

₹27k–45k

per month @ 3k sessions

2 Curated partnerships (FNP, IGP, etc.)

Partner suggestions go in a clearly labelled 'Buy this kind of gift' section. Never ranked by payment. Clearly labelled as 'Sponsored' and no changes in existing logic for recommendation.

Assumptions: ₹300-600 per converted purchase.

EST. REVENUE

₹14k–28k

per month @ 3k sessions

Distribution channels

WhatsApp communities

Target: First 100 users from this channel alone, zero ad spend

Gifting conversations happens in WhatsApp groups and communities before they happen anywhere else. GiftSense is the perfect answer to that question on 'what to buy for my boss?' and the format (no signup, instant result, shareable link) fits exactly how WhatsApp referrals work.

Approach: Send GiftSense to 30 people personally. Build one good success story from those initial users and ask them to share results to multiple whatsapp groups via shareable results link from Giftsense.

Creator & gift guide content

Target: 100-500 organic sessions/month

Building SEO for high-intent, low-competition search terms with no good answers like 'Best Diwali gifts for parents', 'Birthday gift ideas for best friend India', 'Anniversary gift for wife under 5000'. The existing gift guides are generic SEO lists from FNP and Amazon. GiftSense can rank for these terms with content that actually demonstrates the product, not just mentions it.

Approach: Publish 'GiftSense vs Google search vs FNP' comparison content. Rank better for 'personalized gift ideas India'. Write 3-5 blog posts as detailed gift-finding case studies.

HR & people teams — direct outreach

Target: 2-5 paying corporate accounts from 1 Diwali outreach campaign

Every mid-size Indian company gifts 50–500 employees every Diwali. The HR person responsible for this spends weeks on it. GiftSense solves this problem by getting personalized gift recommendation for each employee via bulk upload of interest input from employees.

Approach: LinkedIn cold DMs to HR Managers, People Ops leads, and Executive Assistants at 20-50 person startups in Bangalore, Delhi and Mumbai.